

The new Banana Pi has a RISC-V processor

Banana Pi has introduced the Banana Pi BPI-F3; it has broken tradition by adopting a RISC-V processor, a move that is bound to catch the attention of tech enthusiasts and developers alike. The centrepiece is the SpacemiT RISC-V K1 processor, a 64-bit, 8-core chip touted by the company. While it may not match the blazing speeds of its ARM counterparts, with single-core performance akin to a 1.3GHz ARM Cortex-A55 processor, it promises an intriguing entry point into the world of RISC-V architecture.

Beyond its processing power, it has various features to cater to diverse computing needs. The K1 chip supports 4K video encoding and decoding, delivers up to 2 TOPS of AI performance, and accommodates up to 16GB of LPDDR4/x memory. It doesn't skimp on connectivity options. With 5 lanes of PCIe 2.1 support and an M.2 slot, users can expand their setup with SSDs, wireless modems, or other expansion cards seamlessly. The board also offers a generous selection of ports, including two RJ45 Ethernet ports, HDMI, USB Type-A and Type-C ports, a microSD card reader, and a 3.5mm audio jack, along with a 26-pin GPIO header.

A curious detail emerges from the product announcement regarding the USB interfaces. While it states "1x USB 3.0 + 2x USB 2.0 interfaces," images suggest the presence of four USB 3.x ports, sparking speculation about additional connection points. The details regarding pricing and availability remain under wraps, with Banana Pi expected to unveil more information closer to the launch date. With its fusion of RISC-V architecture and versatile features, it holds promise as a compelling platform for exploration and innovation in the world of single-board computing.

ReactOS overhauls GUI install setup

ReactOS, often hailed as the 'open source Windows', has rolled out a substantial upgrade, primarily focusing on refining its graphical user interface (GUI) installation process. This comes on the heels of the November 2023 release, where



ReactOS achieved 64-bit UEFI bootability across a wider array of devices. The recent update addresses the GUI-mode setup, offering users an alternative to the existing text-mode installer, known as 'USETUP'.

ReactOS justified this move by emphasising the importance of a user-friendly interface. The

project, aiming to be a viable Windows alternative, seeks to provide a streamlined experience comparable to its proprietary counterpart.

The GUI setup introduces a wizard-style interface, allowing users to navigate back and forth between different pages, departing from the linear approach of the text-mode USETUP. Displayed through a series of screenshots, the GUI design echoes the simplicity of classic Windows setups, reminiscent of Windows 95. Users can easily choose the target directory for ReactOS installation through the 'Advanced Options'.

However, the update comes with a caveat. Despite UEFI support, GPT (GUID Partition Table) functionality remains absent. ReactOS users anticipating GPT benefits will need to wait for future releases, as the current update does not address this limitation.

Progress announces an update to OpenEdge

Progress has unveiled the latest update to its application development platform, OpenEdge, marking a significant stride in infrastructure software. It serves over 100,000 customers worldwide and is a pivotal tool in enhancing critical business



applications' development, deployment, and management, ensuring they are more secure, scalable, and agile.

The platform is designed to cater to diverse professionals, from ABL (Advanced Business Language) developers and database administrators to security experts, by offering improved productivity tools,

streamlined management capabilities, and advanced security measures.

The new version introduces significant enhancements to developer productivity. Integrating OpenTelemetry offers comprehensive observability through operational metrics and trace information, aiding in application management and performance optimisation. Additionally, incremental build support facilitates rapid development cycles by allowing quick rebuilds of affected codebase sections.